

Scrying, Sigils, and the Doorways of the Western Tradition

A practical guide to the Western tradition of astral work: the foundational skills of relaxation, breath, and visualisation, the territory and denizens of the inner planes, the arts of protection and inner guidance, and the doorway systems of the Tattwas, mirrors, Tarot, and sigil craft.

The astral faculty is trained the same way any other faculty is trained: through patient, structured repetition. These pages set out that structure in full, drawn from the Golden Dawn current and the wider Western esoteric tradition, alongside the sources listed in the bibliography.

PART ONE

Foundations

Relaxation, breath, concentration, and visualisation: the four core skills every astral working rests on.

PART THREE

Protection & Inner Work

Self-defence, vision correction, the inner guide, and the Tattwa, mirror, and Tarot doorway systems.

PART TWO

Projection & Navigation

The forms astral work takes, and the maps and inhabitants of the territory you will be moving through.

PART FOUR

Will-Work & Practice

Sigil craft for directed intention, and a complete working template that ties the whole system together.

The Four Foundations

Before any serious astral work, you need a solid grounding in four core skill areas. These are the actual engine that makes everything else work, not optional extras. If your astral work is inconsistent or unreliable, the answer is almost always to strengthen one of these four. They build on each other sequentially, though in practice you will be developing all four at once.

① **Relaxation and Breath**

Physical stillness and stable, controlled breathing. The body must be quiet before the mind can move freely.

② **Concentration and Meditation**

The ability to hold a single object of attention without wavering. This is the foundation of all directed will.

③ **Visualisation and Imagination**

Active, controlled inner imagery, distinct from daydreaming in that it is deliberate, directed, and repeatable.

④ **Trans-Location**

The ability to shift the sense of self and perception to points outside the physical body. The goal of all the preceding work.

Progressive Deep Relaxation is the standard pre-work preparation. Do it before any astral session, any visualisation practice, and any serious meditation. It takes ten to fifteen minutes when done properly, and it genuinely changes the quality of everything that follows. Do not skip it because you are in a hurry: a tense body produces noisy, unreliable inner work.

Work systematically through the body from the extremities inward, left to right, toes to crown. For each area, inhale and bring your awareness there, hold the breath and tense that muscle group firmly, then exhale and consciously let go. The release on the exhale is the whole point. Train yourself to feel the difference between held tension and genuine release.

① **Position**

Lie or sit comfortably. Close your eyes. Take a few natural breaths and settle.

② **Left Toes**

Inhale, bring awareness to the left toes. Hold and squeeze. Exhale and release all tension from the area.

③ **Right Toes**

Repeat on the right side. Then spiral progressively through the whole body, left to right.

④ **Whole Body**

Complete the full cycle. If residual tension remains anywhere, repeat the sequence for that area.

Order matters less than thoroughness. Some practitioners work feet to head, others head to feet, others move limb by limb from the outside in. Pick one order and use it consistently: the value of the practice comes largely from its repetition and predictability, which is what allows the body to drop into it quickly over time.

A NOTE ON FALLING ASLEEP

If you fall asleep during relaxation, that is useful information: your body is overtired. Address sleep before attempting serious astral work.

Two common faults undermine this practice. The first is rushing: treating relaxation as a formality to get through before the 'real' work begins, rather than as real work in itself. The second is over-tensing to the point of strain, which produces a rebound of tension on release rather than a clean letting go. Aim for a firm, clear squeeze, held for a slow count of five to seven, followed by a full and complete release.

Signs You Are Ready

Limbs feel heavy or pleasantly absent. Breathing has slowed and deepened on its own. The mind has quieted without effort. Time sense has loosened slightly.

Signs You Are Not Yet Ready

Restlessness or the urge to check the time. Residual tension you cannot locate precisely. Racing or looping thoughts. Physical discomfort you have not addressed.



The seven working zones of Progressive Deep Relaxation, worked in sequence from the toes to the crown.

A shorter variant, useful once the full sequence is well established, works in three zones rather than seven: legs as a single unit, torso and arms as a single unit, then head and neck. This compressed version takes three to four minutes and is suitable as a quick settling practice before a brief midday session, though it should not replace the full seven-zone version as your primary training form.

BUILDING THE HABIT

Practise the full relaxation daily for at least three weeks before judging whether it is working for you. Like any physical skill, the nervous system needs repetition to learn the pattern of release; a single session, however well done, will not produce the deep, near-instant settling that regular practitioners eventually report.

Some students ask whether relaxation practice can be replaced by simply lying down and resting. It cannot. Ordinary rest allows tension to remain wherever it happens to sit; the deliberate tense-then-release cycle used here actively locates and clears tension the body has stopped reporting to conscious awareness. This is the actual mechanism that makes the rest of the book's practices reliable, since a body carrying hidden tension produces correspondingly noisy and unstable inner work.

Breath, Gaze, and Symbol

Square breathing is a structured breath cycle that stabilises the nervous system and, when layered with correspondences, begins to actively engage the elemental and astral framework. Start with the basic four-count cycle and get it steady before adding any additional layers. The count is eight beats per side; use a slow, comfortable internal rhythm.

The Basic Cycle

1. Inhale for 8 2. Hold for 8 3. Exhale for 8 4. Hold outside for 8

With Colour & Element

1. Inhale: Yellow, Air 2. Hold: Red, Fire 3. Exhale: Blue, Water 4. Hold outside: Black, Earth

Once the basic colour and element layer is stable, extend the system to include any set of fourfold correspondences you are working with: seasons, directions, tattwas, senses, chakras, animals, gods and goddesses. Work with one additional layer at a time until it becomes automatic before adding another.

Trataka, steady gazing, is one of the most direct and practical concentration practices available. It produces results quickly, it is clearly measurable, you either held the gaze or you did not, and it directly develops the capacity for inner visual work. Use it as your primary concentration training. The practice trains the eyes and the inner visual faculty simultaneously: the afterimage you see when you close your eyes is genuine visual data being held by the nervous system. Observe it stably, without chasing or forcing, until it fades, then repeat.

1 Setup

Place a candle at arm's length and at eye height. Sit one arm's distance away in a comfortable, stable position.

2 Gaze

Gaze gently at the glowing top of the wick. Keep the gaze soft: you are looking, not staring hard.

3 Hold

Continue gazing until the urge to blink becomes strong. Resist blinking as long as comfortable.

4 Inner Gaze

Close eyes and hold the afterimage steady at the third eye. When the image fades, open eyes and repeat.

Build up gradually. A beginner might hold the outer gaze for thirty seconds and the afterimage for a similar span. Over weeks of regular practice, both stretch out considerably. Do not force the eyes to stay open past genuine strain, and do not chase a fading afterimage by squeezing the eyes shut tighter: both habits produce eye fatigue rather than skill.

Symbols in astral work are functional tools, not decorative elements. Each one is a concentrated form that carries its own energy and associations. The work here is to hold a symbol clearly in the inner visual field, with genuine stability, for an extended period. Start simple: an equal-armed cross in clear white-blue light is harder to hold steadily than it sounds.

Build the skill progressively. Two-dimensional comes first: see the symbol flat, floating in the darkness of space, as if projected against the inside of your eyelids. When that is reliable, move to three-dimensional, then add rotation. Each stage is a genuine increase in skill, not just a variation.

Progression: Work in This Order

1. Equal-armed cross, triangle, circle, square, infinity symbol, spiral. 2. Astrological symbols, alchemical symbols, signs of the planets, ankh, Eye of Horus. 3. Tattwas, runes, Tarot cards, I Ching trigrams and hexagrams, Hebrew letters.

Technique

1. Visualise in white-blue light. 2. See in 2D first, flat in dark space. 3. Advanced: visualise in 3D. 4. Advanced plus: rotate and spin the object.

WORKING LOG

Keep a simple log of your symbol work: the symbol, how long you held it clearly, and what disrupted it when it slipped. Over time this log becomes a precise map of your own particular strengths and weak points, far more useful than a general impression of 'good' or 'bad' practice.



The basic square breathing cycle: inhale, hold, exhale, hold, each phase given an equal count.

A frequent early difficulty with square breathing is an uneven count: the exhale phase often runs shorter than the inhale because the practitioner unconsciously rushes to get the outward breath finished. Counting aloud in a whisper for the first few practice sessions corrects this quickly, since it forces every phase to actually occupy its full share of the cycle rather than being estimated.

COMBINING WITH SYMBOL WORK

Once square breathing is stable on its own, combine it directly with symbol visualisation: hold your chosen symbol steady through one full four-count cycle before allowing it to fade. This single combined exercise, five to ten minutes daily, does more for overall stability of inner work than either practice alone.

FOUNDATIONS
CHAPTER THREE

Imagination and Trans-Location

These exercises train the ability to shift the felt sense of self, where you seem to be located, which is the core mechanism behind all projection work. They range from strongly kinaesthetic (the falling feeling) to purely visual (mirror merging). Work through all of them and find which modes come most naturally to you. The ones that feel easy are your entry points; the ones that feel difficult are where your growth is.

The Fall

Lie down, brace arms and legs, contract stomach muscles, and feel yourself falling at great speed through space.

Himalaya Float

Imagine yourself in the Himalayas, floating through the air above the peaks.

Mirror Merge

Visualise yourself in a mirror in front of you. Then merge with the image and step into it.

Soap Bubble

Imagine yourself as a soap bubble floating freely in space: weightless, transparent, drifting.

The Door

Imagine a door at the top of your head. Feel yourself being drawn out through it, sucked upward.

Ceiling Writing

See yourself rising to the ceiling. Turn it into a blackboard. Write your name in red, yellow, white, and blue chalk.

A final exercise, object manipulation in space with eyes open, is distinct from the others. It is done in ordinary waking consciousness, eyes open, attempting to mentally move or interact with objects in your physical environment. It bridges inner work and outer perception.

THE DOORWAY

The Doorway exercise bridges the imagination practices and actual projection work. A door or portal functions as a psychological and astral threshold. Give it physical qualities: weight, texture, colour, the feel of the handle. The more concrete and specific your imagined doorway, the more functional it becomes as an actual working portal. Many practitioners settle on one consistent doorway image and use it throughout their career.

Do not switch doorway images from session to session in the hope that a different one will work better. A doorway gains its functional strength precisely through repetition: the tenth time you approach the same remembered door, it opens more readily than the first, because the whole imagined structure, its weight, its sound, the texture under your hand, has become genuinely familiar territory to your inner faculties rather than a fresh invention each time.

Trans-location is the practice of shifting your point of perception, the place from which you seem to be seeing and experiencing, to locations outside the physical body. This is distinct from visualisation. In visualisation you see something. In trans-location you are somewhere. The difference in quality of experience, when it works, is clear.

The core insight is that consciousness is not actually fixed inside the skull. That sense of being located behind the eyes is a habit, not a fact. These exercises loosen that habit gradually and systematically. Start with small shifts, such as a foot in front of you or a point above your head, before attempting larger ones.

Points to 'See' From

Various body parts (hands, feet, top of head). Various angles around the room. The ceiling, looking down at yourself. Outside your window, looking in. Outside your building. Above the Earth (advanced).

Trans-Location Practice Sequence

Work through these six exercises in order, each asking for a slightly larger shift in perspective. Spend time with each until it produces a genuine, if brief, felt shift before moving on.

1 One Foot Ahead

Concentrate on a point one foot in front of the body. Without moving physically, attempt to move your awareness toward it.

2 Rise Up

Concentrate on a spot directly above you and attempt to rise toward it.

3 One Foot Above

Try to merge with a point one foot and two inches above the body.

4 Throat Point

Imagine a point two feet in front of the throat. Move toward it, then merge with it.

5 Forward Speed

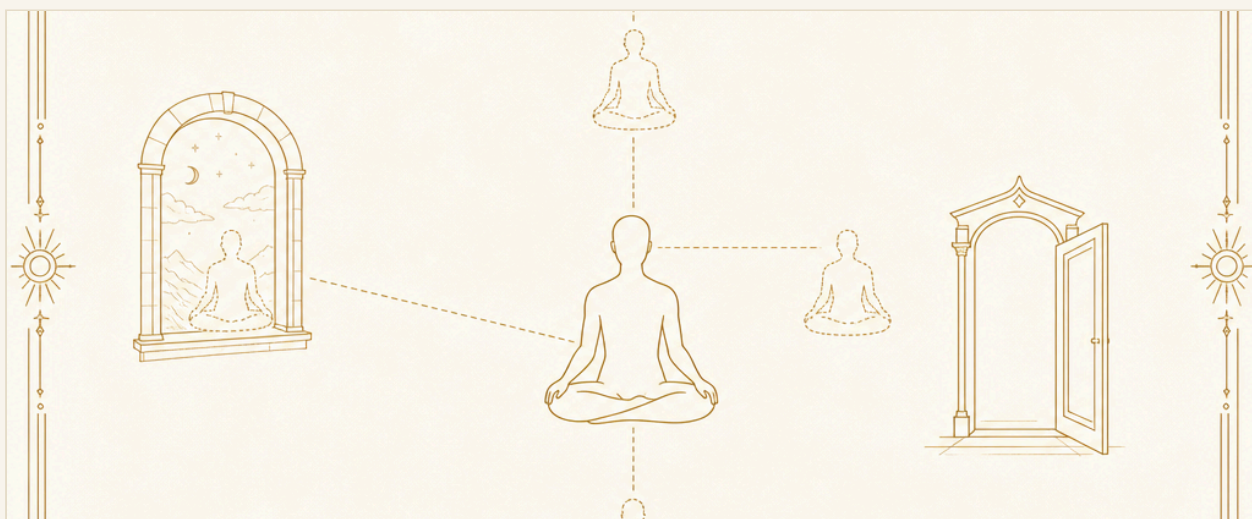
Sit in a chair and imagine yourself moving forward at great speed through space.

6 House Walk

"Walk" around your house from a projected perspective, examining everything in detail.

PATIENCE OVER FORCE

None of these exercises should be forced. A genuine shift, even a brief flicker of it, is worth far more than an hour of straining. If nothing happens after several honest attempts, stop, rest, and return another day. This work rewards patience and punishes impatience fairly directly.



Trans-location practice: shifting the felt point of perception outward from the body to progressively further points, using a consistent doorway as the working threshold.

Keep a short log for this stage as well, noting which exercise you practised, how many minutes you spent, and whether any genuine shift, however brief, occurred. Students who log consistently tend to notice their own progress much sooner than those who practise the same exercises without any written record, since a felt sense of stagnation is often simply a failure to notice the small, real gains accumulating session to session.

PROJECTION & NAVIGATION

CHAPTER FOUR

Astral Projection and Scrying

These four categories cover the main modes of astral work used in the Western tradition, ordered roughly from easiest to most demanding, though individual variation is significant. Know which type you are working with at any given time, as the method and the risks differ.

Scrying in the Spirit Vision

The magician remains physically grounded while the inner eye perceives astral content. The primary method for most working purposes.

Projection Out of the Body

The classic OBE. Consciousness separates from the physical body and moves independently in the astral or etheric layers.

Projection in the Spirit

A deeper mode of spirit vision where the consciousness is more fully engaged in the astral environment, though the body remains in place.

Projection in the Physical

The most advanced and least common form. Involves a degree of physical manifestation or physical-plane interaction from the projected state.

For most practical working purposes, scrying in the spirit vision is the workhorse method. It is controllable, repeatable, and relatively safe. Develop it thoroughly before pursuing the deeper projection modes.

Scrying uses a symbol or image as a threshold, a doorway into an inner landscape. The symbol is not the destination; it is the door. You concentrate on it, hold it in the inner visual field, and then step through it to perceive what lies beyond. Different symbols open into different territories. Systematic scrying of a complete symbol set, such as the Tattwas or the Hebrew letters, provides a comprehensive map of the inner world.

Primary Doorway Systems

Tattwas, runes, sacred symbols (general), I-Ching hexagrams and trigrams, Hebrew letters.

Extended Systems

Alchemical symbols, astrological symbols, Enochian letters and pyramids, Tarot (also used for pathworking).

A useful early exercise is to scry the same simple symbol on several different occasions and compare notes across sessions. Use an equal-armed cross or a plain circle rather than anything with a specific traditional territory attached, so you are studying your own process rather than a particular doorway's content. Track how quickly the doorway opens, how stable the vision is, and how much detail you retain. This gives you a genuine baseline before you move on to symbols with fixed traditional associations.

CHOOSING YOUR FIRST WORKING SYMBOL

Beginners often ask which symbol to start with. The honest answer is: whichever one you can hold steadily for the longest without strain, tested directly rather than guessed at. Spend one session each with a cross, a triangle, and a circle, note which came easiest, and build your early scrying practice around that one before branching out.

Session Length

Ten to fifteen minutes for early scrying sessions is plenty. Longer sessions do not produce proportionally more result and tend to invite drifting concentration. Extend duration only once the shorter sessions are reliably productive.

Working Alone vs. With Others

Solo scrying is the standard starting format. Group scrying, where several people work the same symbol and compare notes afterward, is a valuable later exercise for cross-checking your own reliability against independent accounts.

Keep a plain log for this early stage: date, symbol used, time to doorway opening, and a brief note on stability and detail. Reviewing ten or twenty such logs together reveals your own personal learning curve far more clearly than any single session can, and it also tells you honestly whether you are ready to move on to symbols with fixed traditional territory attached.

Knowing which of the four modes you are actually in matters because the correct response to a difficulty differs sharply between them. A disturbance during spirit vision scrying is corrected by adjusting your focus or breaking the gaze; the same disturbance during a full out-of-body projection calls for a deliberate, unhurried return to the body, never a panicked snap back.

Return Cues, Spirit Vision

Open the eyes. Take a full breath. Note what you saw before it fades. No physical re-entry needed since the body was never left.

Return Cues, Full Projection

Recall the doorway you used to enter and retrace it deliberately. Feel the pull back toward the body as a gentle, welcome draw rather than a jolt. Settle fully before standing up.

A frequent early experience is a kind of double consciousness: part of your attention is clearly ‘there’ in the vision, while another part remains aware of the room, your breathing, the chair beneath you. This is not a failure of the technique. It is the normal early form of the skill, and it typically resolves into a cleaner, more singular focus as practice deepens.

COMMON EXPERIENCE	WHAT IT USUALLY MEANS	WHAT TO DO
Vision feels flat or thin	Concentration not yet stable	Return to Trataka and symbol-holding training
Vision is vivid but forgotten fast	Recording habit not yet built	Record within minutes of returning, every time
Sudden fear or unease appears	Contact with an unfamiliar or testing presence	Use the Sign of the Enterer to test, Silence to withdraw
Nothing happens at all	Relaxation or symbol work is incomplete	Do not force it; strengthen the foundations first

ON PATIENCE WITH THIS CHAPTER

Of all the material in this guide, projection and scrying are the skills most often rushed. Students frequently attempt full out-of-body projection before the foundational work in Chapters One through Three is genuinely solid. The order given here is not arbitrary; it reflects what actually works reliably over time.



The four modes of astral work, from innermost to outermost: scrying in the spirit vision, projection in the spirit, projection out of the body, and projection in the physical.

It is worth stating plainly that most of the genuinely useful magical work described elsewhere in this guide, pathworking, Tattwa scrying, contact with an Inner Guide, is carried out entirely within the first of these four modes. A practitioner who never progresses to a full out-of-body projection has not failed at astral work; they have simply specialised in its most controllable and, for most practical purposes, most productive form.

Questions Beginners Ask

How will I know if it worked? Will I get stuck outside my body? What if I see something frightening? Is a partial or vague result still real progress?

Honest Answers

Most first genuine results are subtle rather than dramatic. Return is automatic; fear or distraction pulls you back instantly. Anything frightening is managed with the tools in Chapters Six and Seven. Partial and vague results are entirely normal and count as real data.

LOGGING IS THE WHOLE METHOD

Every technique in this chapter improves faster with a written log than without one. Note the date, the mode attempted, what you did to prepare, and what actually happened, however small. Read back through a month of entries and you will usually find a clear trend that was invisible session to session.

Expect the early stages of this work to feel inconsistent. One session will bring a vivid, stable vision; the next, worked identically, will bring almost nothing. This unevenness is characteristic of a skill still consolidating, not a sign that something is wrong with your method. Consistency across sessions is what several months of regular, well-logged practice actually builds.

PROJECTION & NAVIGATION

CHAPTER FIVE

Maps and Denizens of the Astral

The astral does not have clearly defined borders. Every tradition that has explored it has produced its own map, and none of them is simply wrong: they are different frameworks for navigating the same territory. The important thing is to have at least one working map in your head when you go in. You can revise your model later based on experience.

The maps below are drawn from a wide range of traditions. Familiarity with several is useful because different maps reveal different features of the territory. An Enochian framework will show you things a Buddhist cosmological model will not foreground, and vice versa.

Western Esoteric

Sphere of Yesod, Enochian Tablets, the Four Realms of Faery, elemental realms, Theosophical planes, the Qliphoth.

Eastern

Lokas, Tibetan Bardos, Buddhist realms, Sufi cosmology, Egyptian maps.

Shamanic

The Three Worlds (Upper, Middle, Lower), Robert Monroe's framework, the Mayan seven levels, Valhalla.

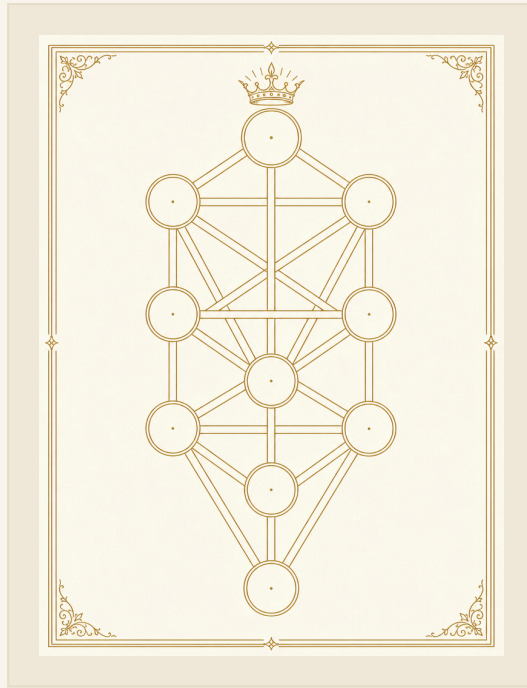
Classical / Mythological

Heaven and Hell, Elysium, Realms of the Gods, Realms of Demons, elemental four.

Choosing a primary map is a practical decision, not a doctrinal one. If your other magical work is grounded in the Qabalah, the Sphere of Yesod and the broader Tree of Life framework will integrate cleanly with everything else you are doing. If you work primarily within a shamanic frame, the Three Worlds model will likely feel more natural and will connect more directly with your existing practice. Use whichever map lets you work, and hold it loosely enough to revise as direct experience accumulates.

MAP	ROUGH STRUCTURE	BEST SUITED TO
Tree of Life / Yesod	Ten spheres, twenty-two connecting paths	Qabalistic or Golden Dawn-based practice
Three Worlds	Upper, Middle, Lower	Shamanic or animistic practice
Tibetan Bardos	Sequential intermediate states	Death-and-rebirth focused inner work
Elemental Realms	Four (or five, with Spirit) linked regions	Tattwa-based scrying practice

Whichever map you adopt, resist the temptation to treat it as literally, physically true in the way a street map is true. It is a working model, useful because it is consistent and navigable, not because it has been proven to correspond point for point with some objective territory. Hold your map with the same practical seriousness you would give any other tool: use it fully, and stay willing to redraw sections of it as your own logged experience accumulates.



The Tree of Life: ten spheres and twenty-two connecting paths, the primary map used in Qabalistic and Golden Dawn-based astral work. The sphere of Yesod, ninth from the crown, is the traditional gateway to the astral plane proper.

YESOD AS GATEWAY

In the Tree of Life system, Yesod, the ninth sphere, associated with the Moon, is specifically the sphere of the astral light and the foundation of the visible universe. Scrying and projection work in this framework is often understood as an ascent through Yesod before moving further up the Tree, which is one reason lunar and reflective symbolism, mirrors, water, silver, recurs so often across astral practice generally.

The astral is populated. What you encounter there ranges from the straightforwardly helpful to the actively problematic, with a large middle category of things that are simply neutral and going about their own business. Knowing the categories helps you respond appropriately when you meet something, rather than reacting from surprise or projection.

Do not assume everything you encounter is significant or has a message for you specifically. Most of what populates the astral is not particularly interested in you. The things that do approach you warrant more careful attention, both the helpful and the less helpful varieties.

Guides & Helpers

Inner guides, animal spirits, angels, plant spirits, ancestors.

Other Travellers

Astral travellers, magicians, shamans, dreamers.

Inhabitants

Fae and nature spirits, elementals, gods and goddesses, magical creatures, egregores and servitors.

Difficult Entities

Ghosts, demons, vampires, parasites, the Dweller on the Threshold.

Alien & Unknown

Aliens, nameless blobs and lights, beings and powers without clear category.

Human Artifacts

Thought-forms, constructed environments, Tarot Trump guardians, egregores.

A practical rule of thumb: guides and helpers tend to approach calmly and leave you feeling clearer, steadier, or genuinely instructed. Difficult entities tend to produce a felt sense of drain, unease, or pressure, often before any overtly hostile action occurs. Trust that early felt sense. It is usually more reliable than trying to reason your way through an encounter in the moment.

How to Respond, Helpful Contacts

Greet calmly. Ask their name and purpose if it is not clear. Listen fully before acting on anything offered. Thank them and let the contact close naturally.

How to Respond, Difficult Contacts

Do not engage in argument or bargaining. Use a banishing sign (Chapter Six) immediately. Withdraw cleanly rather than fleeing in a panic, which tends to destabilise the whole session.

A NOTE ON PROJECTION OF YOUR OWN MATERIAL
A significant amount of what looks alarming on the astral is your own unprocessed material meeting you in symbolic form, not an external entity at all. This does it does change the correct response: such material usually responds to acknowledgement and inner work rather than banishing.

Over time, most practitioners build a personal bestiary: a working list of the beings, guides, and recurring figures they actually encounter, distinct from the general categories above. This personal record is more valuable than any general reference, since your own astral neighbourhood, so to speak, develops recognisable regular inhabitants the longer and more consistently you work in it.

ON NAMING
Do not assume a name given to you by an entity is necessarily its true or complete name; many astral inhabitants offer a working name suited to the contact, rather than their full name in whatever their own system of address happens to be. Use the given name respectfully and consistently within your own practice, while holding it a little more loosely than you would a name given by a source you trust completely.

FIRST IMPRESSION	LIKELY CATEGORY	TYPICAL NEXT STEP
Calm, warm, steadying	Guide or helper	Engage openly, ask its name and purpose
Neutral, going about its business	Ordinary inhabitant	Observe respectfully, do not interfere
Draining, pressuring, insistent	Difficult entity	Banish or withdraw, log the encounter
Oddly familiar, emotionally loaded	Your own material	Acknowledge it, work with it directly rather than banishing

None of these categories are perfectly airtight, and a single encounter can shift from one to another as it develops. Treat the table above as a first read, useful for deciding how to respond in the first few seconds of contact, and let your own accumulating log of encounters refine your judgment far beyond what any general table can offer.

PROTECTION & INNER WORK
CHAPTER SIX

Self-Defence and Negative Entities

This is practical material. The astral is not universally friendly, and having a working toolkit for protection and banishing is basic hygiene, not paranoia. Most experienced practitioners develop a personal set of go-to methods that they can deploy quickly and without much deliberate thought. Build yours systematically before you need it under pressure.

Invocation & Prayer

Ask and call for spiritual aid and protection. Simple and often immediately effective.

Constructed Defences

Astral armour, shields, and weapons, formed and held in the imagination with genuine force.

Active Methods

Electric-violet flame, shape-shifting, martial arts techniques, affirmation, exorcism.

Signs & Symbols

Sword mudra, sacred signs, pentagrams, the LBRP, sigils, geometric forms.

Sound & Smell

Names and shouts of power, vibrated calls, salt, garlic, frankincense.

Layer these methods rather than relying on a single one. A typical protective sequence for serious work might combine a banishing ritual before beginning (Signs & Symbols), a held mental image of protection throughout (Constructed Defences), and a vibrated name or word ready to deploy if something genuinely difficult appears (Sound & Smell). Redundancy is a strength here, not overkill.

BUILD YOUR OWN CORE SEQUENCE

Rather than trying to master every method listed above at once, pick one from each category and drill that specific combination until it is fast and automatic. Under real pressure you will reach for what you have actually rehearsed, not what merely sounded good on the page. Revisit and refine the sequence periodically as your practice matures.

A basic astral shield, held as a sphere or dome of steady light around the body, is worth building early and reinforcing at the start of every session, whether or not anything difficult is expected. Treat it the way you would treat locking a door: routine, not a sign that anything is wrong. The habit itself does much of the protective work, since a consistently shielded practitioner rarely needs to improvise a defence under pressure.

Signs You Are Under Genuine Attack

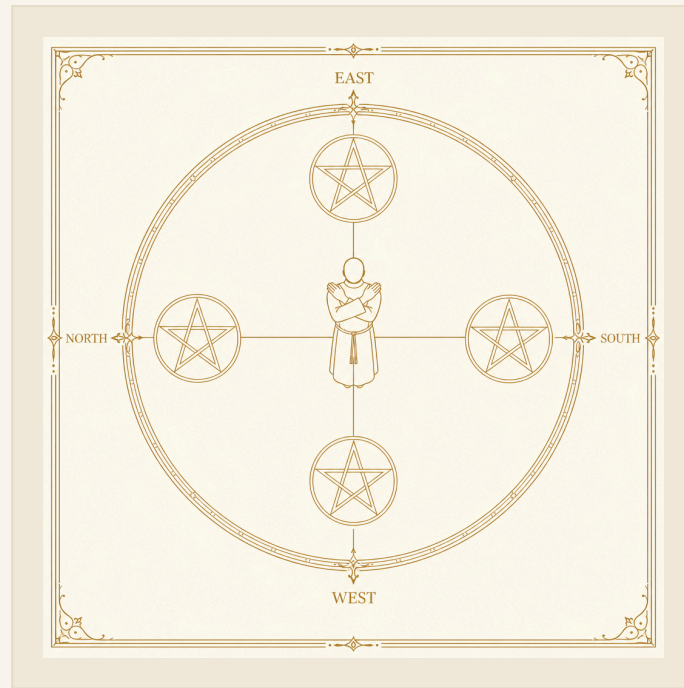
Persistent, escalating unease that does not lift when the session ends. Repeated identical imagery across unrelated sessions. Physical effects: nausea, chill, sudden heavy fatigue with no ordinary cause.

Signs You Are Simply Anxious

Unease that lifts once you ground and open your eyes. Vague, shifting imagery with no consistent character. No effect that persists past the session itself.

DO NOT OVER-DIAGNOSE

The great majority of unsettling sessions are the second category, ordinary anxiety or unprocessed material, not genuine attack. Treat every session as the milder case first: ground, breathe, and reassess in daylight before assuming you need heavier defensive measures.



The Lesser Banishing Ritual of the Pentagram: the four cardinal quarters, each sealed with a banishing pentagram, the practitioner standing at the centre facing East.

Negative entities exist in the subtle electromagnetic field around the Earth. They are real, they vary considerably in type, class, and power, and they operate according to consistent patterns, which means they are manageable once you understand what conditions they favour and which they avoid. The Qabalistic model of the Qliphoth provides one useful framework for categorising them.

Conditions They Dislike

Bright lights, happy music. Electrically grounded running water. Cleanliness, hygiene, and good habits. Loud noises. Garlic, sulphur, frankincense. Regular, decent sleep schedules.

Conditions They Prefer

Heavy, violent, dark music and environments. Anywhere free of running water and electrical grounding. Dirt, dust, and destructive habits. Creepy silence. Decay, alcohol, death smells. Disrupted sleep in the potential host.

THE PRACTICAL TAKEAWAY

Maintain yourself and your environment well, and you reduce your exposure significantly. This is direct and literal advice, not a metaphor. Most negative entity problems trace back to a deterioration in basic self-care.

Beyond environment and habit, a settled, well-rested practitioner with a clear daily structure is simply a harder target across every category above. This is worth stating plainly because students often look for an exotic technical fix to a problem that is, in practice, substantially addressed by sleep, food, sunlight, and reducing chaotic or depleting influences in ordinary life.

1 Immediate Response

Stop the working. Ground yourself: feel your feet, open your eyes, take several full breaths.

2 Banish

Perform a banishing ritual or use a protective sign, whichever you have trained most thoroughly.

3 Clean the Space

Open a window, light a candle, burn a cleansing incense such as frankincense or sage.

4 Rest Before Returning

Do not immediately re-attempt the same working. Give it at least a day, and address any lifestyle factors that may have weakened your defences.

WHEN TO SEEK OUTSIDE HELP

If disturbance persists across multiple days, affects your ordinary sleep or waking mood, or is accompanied by physical symptoms with no other explanation, treat it as a matter for a trusted, experienced teacher rather than something to resolve alone through further technique. Isolation tends to make genuine cases worse; a second, calmer set of eyes on the situation is often the single most useful thing you can bring to it.

Finally, keep the whole subject in proportion. The overwhelming majority of practitioners who follow the foundational work in this guide, sound relaxation, stable concentration, a consistent protective sequence, never encounter a genuine difficult entity worth the name. The material in this chapter is best treated as insurance you carry calmly, not as a reason for anxiety about work that is, for most people doing it properly, straightforwardly safe.

A Simple Monthly Habit

Once a month, review your protective sequence the same way you would service any other piece of working equipment: check that the banishing sign is still fast and automatic, that the shield visualisation is still vivid, and that any names or vibrations you rely on are still fresh in memory.

Seasonal Cleansing

Many practitioners pair this review with a simple seasonal cleansing of the working space itself: airing the room, refreshing salt or incense, and a short banishing pass through the whole area, whether or not anything unusual has occurred.

A WORKING PRINCIPLE

Protection in this tradition is built the same way any other skill in this guide is built: through small, repeated, unglamorous practice, rehearsed until it is automatic, rather than through a single dramatic ritual reached for only in a crisis.

PROTECTION & INNER WORK
CHAPTER SEVEN

Vision-Busting: Letters, Names, and Signs

During astral work, a range of common interruptions can destabilise or corrupt a vision. The following Hebrew letters, each associated with a planetary power, are used as specific remedies for specific types of interruption. Each letter must be visualised clearly in the inner visual field, or traced in the air, while the problem is present. All uses require that you know how to vibrate the letter's name effectively.

Tauv, Saturn

To banish interruptions caused by intrusive memories surfacing during a vision.

Peh, Mars

To deal with any aggressive or hostile entities encountered in vision.

Resh, Sun

To overcome ego-inflation, the sense that the vision is confirming your own grandiosity.

Beth, Mercury

To test truth, banish deceitfulness, and eliminate intrusive thoughts.

Gimel, Moon

To refocus a vision that has drifted or become incoherent.

Kaph, Jupiter

To banish intrusive fantasies about the future, wishful thinking dressed up as vision.

Daleth, Venus: to banish intrusive erotic thoughts. Learn all seven of these double letters together as a set, since interruptions rarely announce themselves clearly in advance. Practise vibrating each name aloud, at ordinary volume, until the sound resonates audibly in the chest rather than only in the throat. This physical resonance is what actually does the work; a whispered or purely mental repetition is markedly weaker.



The letter Tauv (Saturn): used to banish intrusive memories and to ground and seal a vision that has run its course.

The elemental hierarchies provide a complete set of divine names that can be vibrated to clear, stabilise, or anchor a working. All names in this system are meant to be vibrated: physically resonated through the chest and body, not simply spoken or thought. The vibration is the operative mechanism. Know these by memory before you need them in an active session.

ELEMENT	EARTH	FIRE	AIR	WATER
Divine Name	Adonai Ha Aretz	YHVH Tzabaoth	Shaddai El Chai	Elohim Tzabaoth
Cardinal Point	Tzaphon (North)	Darom (South)	Mizrach (East)	Maarab (West)
Archangel	Uriel	Michael	Raphael	Gabriel
Angel	Phorlakh	Ariel	Chasan	Tharsis
Elemental King	Ghob	Djinn	Paralda	Nixa
Elemental	Gnomes	Salamanders	Sylphs	Undines

Use the divine name for the element that dominates the working you are doing: the Water names for emotional or scrying work, the Fire names when force or purification is called for, and so on. When in genuine doubt or under real pressure, the four names can be vibrated together in sequence, moving through the cardinal points, as a general-purpose stabilising measure that does not require you to first diagnose exactly what kind of disturbance you are facing.

MEMORISATION MATTERS

There is no substitute for having this table memorised cold. A working session is not the moment to be recalling a reference table; under any real pressure, hesitation itself becomes destabilising. Drill the names and correspondences as a matter of course, the same way you would drill any other core skill in this book.

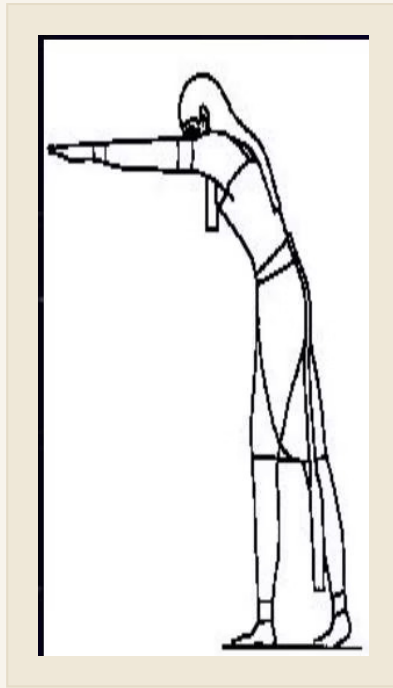
The physical signs used to test and stabilise vision are drawn from Golden Dawn grade work. They operate on the same principle as the letters and names: a concrete, embodied action that engages the astral level. The Sign of the Enterer projects force outward; the Sign of Silence withdraws it and seals. Both are used in combination when challenging or testing what appears in vision.

Sign of the Enterer

Project force. Lean forward, arms extended forward, face obscured. Used to send power into a vision or test an entity.

Sign of Silence

Withdraw and seal. Stand upright, arms crossed on chest. Used immediately after the Sign of the Enterer to prevent backlash.

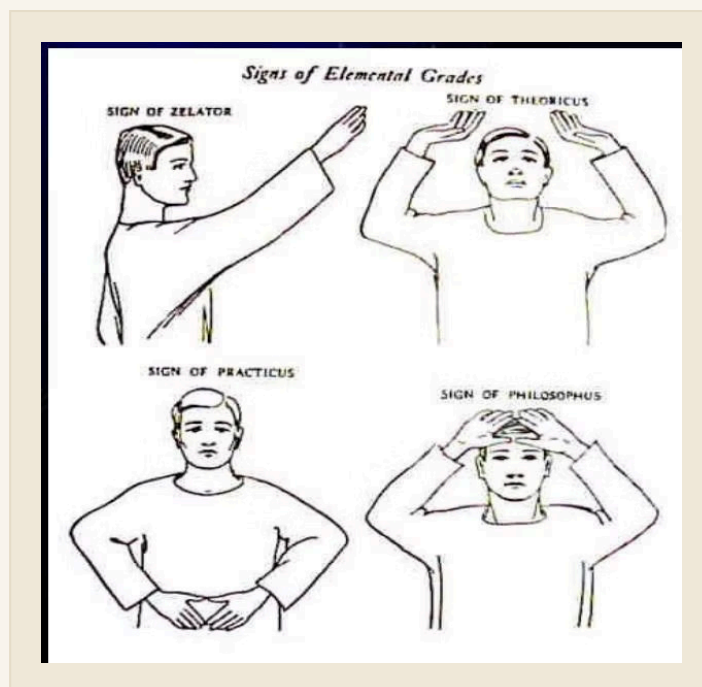


The Sign of the Enterer: force projected outward, used to test or challenge a presence encountered in vision.



The Sign of Silence: arms crossed, withdrawing and sealing the force just projected. Always given immediately after the Sign of the Enterer, regardless of what response it produced.

Each elemental grade also has its own sign: Zelator (Earth), Theoricus (Air), Practicus (Water), Philosophus (Fire). These can be used within vision to identify yourself or to invoke the qualities of the corresponding element. Give each one before entering a working associated with that element, and use it again if you need to reassert your footing partway through a session.



The four elemental grade signs of the Golden Dawn system: Zelator (Earth), Theoricus (Air), Practicus (Water), and Philosophus (Fire).

COMBINING THE TOOLKIT

In a real testing situation, these tools are rarely used alone. A common sequence is: vibrate the relevant divine name, give the Sign of the Enterer to challenge, observe the response, then give the Sign of Silence to withdraw and seal regardless of what the response was. Practise the whole sequence as a single unit until it is automatic.

TOOL	TYPE	USED FOR
Seven double letters	Vibrated Hebrew letters	Correcting a specific kind of disturbance in vision
Four divine names	Vibrated elemental names	General clearing, stabilising, or anchoring a working
Sign of the Enterer	Physical/astral sign	Projecting force to test or challenge a presence
Sign of Silence	Physical/astral sign	Withdrawing and sealing force after a challenge
Elemental grade signs	Physical/astral sign	Identifying yourself or invoking a specific element in vision

None of this toolkit substitutes for the foundational work in earlier chapters. Vibration, signs, and names all work by concentrating and directing a force that the practitioner has already built through relaxation, breath, and concentration training. Used without that foundation, they tend to feel hollow and produce little real effect; used on top of it, they become genuinely fast and reliable.

The Inner Guide and the Tattwas

Active imagination is a technique developed within depth psychology, used extensively in magical practice as a method for making genuine contact with inner intelligences and, through them, with the broader astral. The Inner Guide is a distinct inner figure who functions as a reliable navigator, teacher, and companion for inner work. Finding yours is a significant event in a practitioner's development.

The journey below is a structured method for making initial contact. It uses a consistent landscape: a cave, a transition into open country, an animal guide, and then the Guide itself. Work it slowly. Do not rush the animal contact stage; the animal is important in its own right and acts as an intermediary. When you meet the Guide, the test question is direct and non-negotiable: are you my true Guide?

1 Enter Cave

Begin in darkness, feeling your way forward into the mouth of the cave.

2 Move Forward

Continue walking through the passage until it opens ahead of you.

3 Turn Left

Follow the passage as it turns, trusting the path as it unfolds.

4 Find Opening

Emerge from the cave into open country and look around.

5 Call Guide

Call for an animal to appear as your intermediary, then ask to meet the Guide itself.

VERIFICATION

When you take the Guide's hand and feel their presence, love, protection, acceptance, that quality of feeling is itself the verification. A false figure will not produce it convincingly.

Return to this same journey repeatedly over time rather than treating first contact as a one-off event. The relationship with an Inner Guide deepens through repeated, unhurried visits in the same way any real relationship does. Bring genuine questions. Listen more than you speak. Record every session, including ones that feel uneventful: the pattern across many sessions is often more informative than any single dramatic one.

The Tattwas are a system of elemental symbols originating in Hindu Tantra and adopted into the Western tradition primarily through the Golden Dawn. They function as concentrated elemental doorways. When scryed systematically, they provide access to the full range of elemental environments and beings on the astral. Each symbol has a specific colour and form, and these are not arbitrary: they carry the energetic signature of the element they represent.

Western Alchemical Symbols

Fire: upright triangle with horizontal bar. Water: inverted triangle with horizontal bar. Air: inverted triangle, no bar. Earth: upright triangle, no bar.

Tantric / Tattwa Forms

Yellow square (Earth / Prithvi). Blue circle (Air / Vayu). Silver crescent (Water / Jala). Red triangle (Fire / Tejas). Black or indigo oval (Spirit / Akasha).



The five Tattwa elemental symbols: Prithvi, Vayu, Jala, Tejas, and Akasha, in their traditional colours and forms.

Each primary Tattwa can be combined with every other to produce a sub-division, an elemental compound that represents the quality of one element within the field of another: Earth of Water, or Fire of Air, for example. There are twenty-five combinations in total, including the pure elements. These sub-divisions are used for more refined scrying and for working within specific elemental sub-planes.

The system is visually straightforward: the sub-element symbol is placed inside the primary element's symbol, at a smaller scale and in its own colour. Water of Earth, for example, would be a small silver crescent inside a large yellow square. When creating cards for scrying, reproduce these exactly. Colour accuracy matters here: incorrect colours produce different and often muddled experiences.

Earth (Prithvi)

Yellow square. Sub-divisions place Earth, Air, Water, Fire, and Spirit symbols within. Used for grounding, physical manifestation, and stability work.

Air (Vayu)

Blue circle. The most mentally oriented of the elements. Sub-divisions access states of heightened mental clarity and communication.

Water (Jala)

Silver crescent. Emotional, psychic, reflective. The Water Tattwas are particularly useful for vision work and for working with the astral generally.

Fire (Tejas)

Red triangle. Energising and purifying. Fire sub-divisions are useful for banishing and for work requiring significant force.

Spirit (Akasha)

Black or deep indigo oval. The quintessential element, above and encompassing the four. Spirit sub-divisions open into the broadest astral ranges.

Practical tip for making your own cards: use good stiff card stock, mix or match paints to the exact traditional colours rather than approximations, and make the complementary background (each Tattwa is traditionally painted on its opposite colour) as carefully as the symbol itself. The complementary background is what produces the strong, clean afterimage that the whole scrying method depends on.

ELEMENT	SEASON	DIRECTION	TYPICAL ASTRAL QUALITY
Earth (Prithvi)	Late summer / harvest	North	Solid, stable, grounded landscapes; caves, plains, orchards
Water (Jala)	Winter	West	Reflective, fluid, emotionally charged; lakes, oceans, rain
Air (Vayu)	Spring	East	Open, high, clear; mountaintops, wind, wide skies
Fire (Tejas)	Summer	South	Intense, active, purifying; forges, deserts, volcanic terrain
Spirit (Akasha)	Outside seasonal cycle	Centre / above	Vast, formless, luminous; boundary and threshold spaces

These correspondences are a starting frame, not a rigid rule. Your own logged experience of each Tattwa will, over time, refine and personalise this table considerably. What matters most in early practice is consistency: use the same colours, the same card sizes, and the same basic procedure every time so that variations in your results reflect genuine differences in the elements themselves rather than inconsistencies in your method.

WORKING THE FULL SET OF TWENTY-FIVE

Once the five pure Tattwas are individually reliable, work through the sub-divisions systematically rather than at random: complete every combination within one primary element before moving to the next. This gives you a coherent map of one elemental territory in full before you begin comparing it against another, which makes the differences between elements far easier to recognise clearly.

Students sometimes ask whether the Inner Guide met in the earlier journey and the beings encountered through Tattwa scrying are connected. In practice they often are: an established Guide will frequently appear again within a Tattwa doorway, and can be asked directly to accompany or introduce you to a new elemental territory. Bringing the Guide into this later work is entirely appropriate and, for many practitioners, becomes the natural way the two practices in this chapter come together.

Scrying the Tattwas, Mirrors, and the Tarot

The Earth Tattwa, a yellow square on a purple background, is typically the starting point for Tattwa scrying. It is visually simple, the complementary colour pair produces a strong and clear afterimage, and the Earth plane it opens into is relatively stable and straightforward to navigate. It makes an excellent first doorway for practitioners new to this system.

- ① **Prepare a Tattwa Card**
Yellow square on purple background, approximately palm-sized.
- ② **Relax and Breathe**
Perform your relaxation and breath work first.
- ③ **Gaze**
Hold the card at arm's length and gaze at it steadily, as in Trataka practice.
- ④ **Hold the Afterimage**
Close eyes and hold the afterimage clearly at the third eye.
- ⑤ **Enlarge**
Mentally enlarge the image until it is doorway-sized.
- ⑥ **Step Through**
Visualise yourself stepping through it.
- ⑦ **Observe**
Note carefully and without interpretation everything you perceive.
- ⑧ **Record**
Record immediately on return.

ON RECORDING

Always record your Tattwa visions in full immediately after the session. The astral fades quickly from memory, and the record is your primary research document.

Once Earth is reliable, move through the remaining pure elements in the traditional order: Water, Air, Fire, then Spirit. Each opens into a distinctly different quality of landscape and population, and each also tends to test a different aspect of your stability. Fire scrying in particular can be intense for beginners; do not attempt it until Earth and Water are thoroughly comfortable.

ELEMENT	CARD COLOURS	WHAT TO WATCH FOR
Water	Silver crescent on orange	Emotional content surfacing strongly; do not suppress it, simply observe and record
Air	Blue circle on yellow	Rapid, mentally busy imagery; slow your breath if the vision starts to race
Fire	Red triangle on green	Intensity and heat sensations; withdraw calmly if the session becomes overwhelming
Spirit	Indigo oval on white/grey	Vast, boundary-less quality; keep a firm sense of your own edges throughout

Physical scrying tools function by providing a surface for the inner eye to project onto. The darkness, reflectivity, or movement of the medium gives the visual faculty something to work with, rather than the blankness of closed eyes. Different practitioners respond to different media: some find dark mirrors easier, others water, others still obsidian or black glass. Experiment and find what works for you personally.

Magic Mirrors

Traditionally black-backed mirrors. Work in low or candlelight. Gaze softly at the surface, not into it. The vision occurs in the mind, not literally on the glass.

Dark Mirrors

Any very dark, smooth, reflective surface, such as black glass, obsidian, or dark polished stone. The same technique applies as for magic mirrors.

Water Mirrors / Scrying Pools

Moving or still water in a vessel. The slight movement of water can help stimulate the inner visual faculty for those who find static mirrors difficult.

The water mirror method involves an active visualisation layered onto the physical bowl and water, which then transitions into genuine perception. It is one of the more elegant methods available because the physical preparation, handling the silver bowl and filling and swirling the water, itself functions as a preparatory ritual that primes the inner faculties.

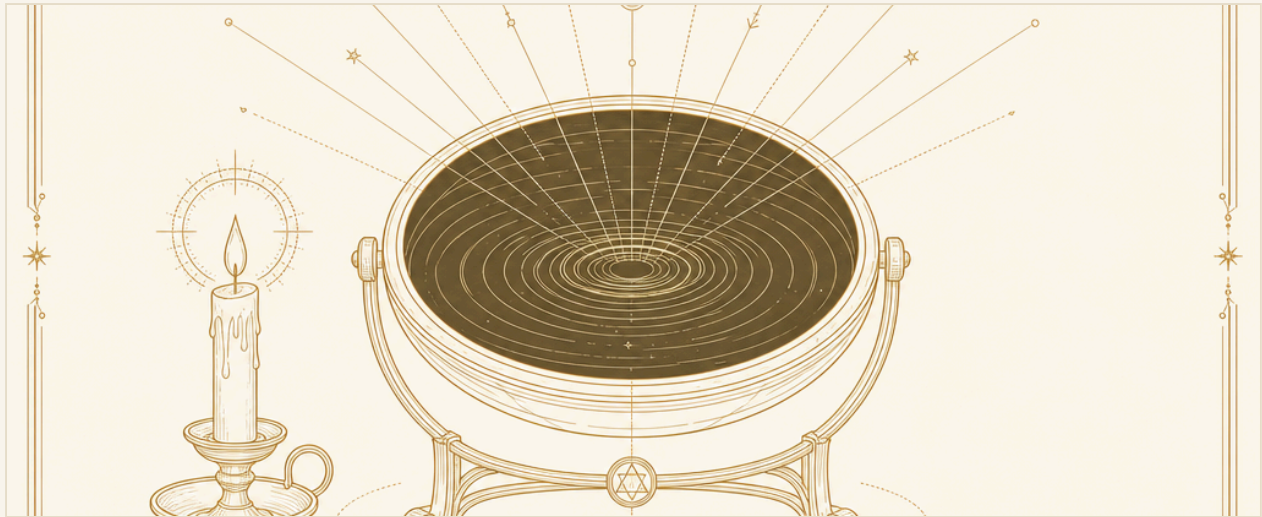
CARING FOR A SCRYING MIRROR

Keep a dedicated mirror or bowl for this purpose only; do not use it for ordinary tasks. Store it wrapped in dark cloth, away from direct light, when not in use. Clean the glass or bowl before each session with plain water, wiping away fingerprints and dust, both for practical clarity and as a small preparatory ritual in itself.

Lighting matters considerably for any mirror-based method. A single candle placed to the side, never directly in front where its flame reflects into the gazing surface, gives enough light to steady the eyes without washing out the faint inner perception you are trying to cultivate. Complete darkness is unnecessary and, for most practitioners, actually makes early sessions harder rather than easier.

A NOTE ON OBSIDIAN AND BLACK GLASS

These stone and glass media hold a particularly strong tradition in Mesoamerican and later Western ceremonial practice. A well-made obsidian mirror is a genuine investment piece; a plain sheet of glass painted black on the reverse works almost as well for most practitioners starting out, and is a sensible first purchase before committing to a more costly traditional mirror.



A dark scrying bowl set beside a single candle. The gentle side-light steadies the eyes without washing out the faint inner perception the practice depends on.

1 Prepare the Bowl

Take a silver or silver-plated bowl. Fill with fresh, clean water.

2 Open the Portal

Visualise a silver-grey clockwise swirling portal above the water's surface. Physically swirl the water slowly to reinforce this.

3 Enlarge

Mentally enlarge the portal image, both in your mind and on the astral, until it is large enough to enter.

4 Dive In

Dive through the portal in your imagination. Move through until you perceive a light ahead.

5 Ascend

Ascend toward the light. Emerge into whatever astral landscape presents itself. Observe and explore.

Each Tarot card, particularly the Major Arcana, is an astral doorway in its own right, as well as a teaching image, a map of a specific inner territory, and a portrait of a specific type of force or being. For scrying purposes, treat the card exactly as you would treat a Tattwa card: gaze at it, internalise it, enlarge it, and step through it. For pathworking, you move through a narrative journey associated with the card's symbolism.

The Major Arcana cards are associated with specific paths on the Qabalistic Tree of Life, and each path has its own set of correspondences (colour, sound, smell, deity, animal, and plant) that can be used to enrich and deepen pathworking sessions.

Scrying a Tarot Card

Gaze at the printed card as you would a Tattwa card. Internalise the whole image, not just the central figure. Enlarge and step through. Suited to short, exploratory sessions.

Pathworking a Tarot Card

Enter a guided narrative built around the card's full symbolism, usually scripted or recorded in advance. A longer, more structured session, better suited to deliberate teaching or initiatory work.

Begin with cards you find visually calm and stable, such as the Empress or the Hermit, before working the more turbulent Trumps such as the Tower or the Devil. As with the Tattwas, log each session: which card, how quickly the doorway opened, and what you perceived. Over time this builds a personal relationship with the Major Arcana that goes considerably beyond their use as a divination deck.

CARD CONDITION MATTERS

Use a deck reserved solely for this purpose rather than one you also use for ordinary reading or divination for others. A dedicated deck accumulates a settled, consistent character over repeated use that a deck handled by many different questions and hands does not develop as cleanly.

The High Priestess (Trump II) is one of the most significant cards for astral and inner work. She stands between the two pillars of the Temple, Jachin and Boaz, positive and negative force, the conscious and the unconscious, and she guards the veil behind which the deeper mysteries lie. Scrying or pathworking this card consistently opens access to the sphere of the Moon (Yesod) and to the deep currents of astral consciousness.

Key Symbols in the Card

The two pillars, B and J: Boaz and Jachin. The scroll inscribed TORA: hidden knowledge. The crescent moon crown: Yesod, astral reflection. The veil behind her: what lies beyond ordinary perception. The cross on her robe: balanced forces.

For Pathworking

Enter the card. Stand before her. Ask her to show you what lies behind the veil. Be patient: she responds to quiet receptivity, not forceful demand. Record everything you perceive, including symbolic images you do not immediately understand.

Hebrew letters appear frequently as signs, guardians, and markers during astral work in the Western tradition. Each letter is associated with a specific path on the Tree of Life, a planetary or elemental force, a Tarot card, and a set of symbols and images. Recognising them in vision is useful; working with them deliberately as doorways is a complete system of practice in its own right.

Gimel, the Moon, the Camel

Path connecting Kether (Crown) to Tiphareth (Beauty), the longest path on the Tree. Associated with the High Priestess, the deep lunar mind, and the crossing of the Abyss. A key letter for astral work generally.

Tau, Saturn, the Cross

The last letter of the Hebrew alphabet. Associated with Saturn, the World card (Trump XXI), and the material world as both completion and limitation. Used in banishing and grounding.

RECOGNISING LETTERS SPONTANEOUSLY

You will not always be deliberately scrying a letter when one appears. Hebrew letters, along with runes and other traditional symbols, sometimes surface unbidden during otherwise unrelated astral work, often at a genuinely significant point in the session. Note the letter, its context, and what happened immediately before and after; do not force an interpretation on the spot.

Building fluency with this whole doorway system, Tattwas, mirrors, and Tarot together, takes months of steady, unhurried practice rather than weeks. Resist the temptation to rush toward more advanced doorways before the earlier ones are thoroughly reliable. Each system reinforces the others: skill gained in Tattwa scrying transfers directly into Tarot pathworking and mirror work, since the underlying faculty being trained is the same in every case.

WILL-WORK & PRACTICE

CHAPTER TEN

Sigil Magic

Sigil magic is direct, practical, and has an excellent track record. The basic principle: you encode your intention into a symbol, charge that symbol, and release it, both psychologically and in some physical form. The encoding process removes the literal verbal content of the intention and replaces it with an abstract form that bypasses the analytical mind's tendency to argue with the working.

There are several well-established methods for creating sigils, all of which work. The Word Method below is the most accessible starting point. Once you have worked with it reliably, explore the Rose-Cross method, the magic square method, and runic bind-runes. The firing and forgetting stage is not optional: it is the point at which the working is actually released to operate.

Word

Letter-based sigil from a written intention statement. The most accessible method.

Picture

A drawn image that represents the desired outcome, abstracted into symbol form.

Rose-Cross

Letters are traced on the Rose-Cross lamen to produce a sigil line.

Runic / Bind-Runes

Runes combined into a single composite symbol encoding the intent.

Magic Squares

Numbers traced on planetary magic squares to produce a unique sigil line.

Automatic Writing

A sigil produced through automatic writing or spontaneous drawing in a light trance.

Materials are flexible: clay, wood, wax, paper, ink. Methods of charging and firing are equally varied: burn, bury, float on water, visualise into a candle flame, ingest (appropriate materials only), or project astrally. The key is that you genuinely release attachment to the outcome after firing.

CHARGING METHODS COMPARED

A quiet, focused build-up of concentration, held for a minute or two immediately before firing, works reliably across every method below. Some practitioners add movement, breath-of-fire, brief physical exertion, or ecstatic states to intensify the charge further; these are optional intensifiers, not required steps.

Quiet Charging

Gaze at the sigil, hold single-pointed concentration, let the design blur slightly at the edge of vision, then fire. Suits most everyday workings.

Gnostic / Ecstatic Charging

Build the charge through brief intense physical or breathing exertion, then fire at the peak, when ordinary thought is momentarily suspended. Suits deeper or more difficult intentions.

This is the classic Austin Osman Spare method, widely used and well-tested. It works by stripping the intention statement down to a set of letters, converting those to numbers, and then tracing a path through a number wheel to produce the final glyph. Follow the stages exactly. Do not skip the firing and forgetting stage.

① **State Your Intent**

Write out your intention clearly and in the present tense. Example: I AM CALM AND CONTENT.

② **Reduce the Letters**

Cross out all vowels and all repeated consonants. From I AM CALM AND CONTENT, this gives M CL ND T.

③ **Assign Numbers**

Use a number-letter grid (A=1, B=2, and so on through I=9, then J=1 again). MCLNDT becomes 433542.

④ **Trace the Path**

Place the number sequence on a number wheel. Draw lines connecting the numbers in sequence. This produces your sigil shape.

⑤ **Fire and Forget**

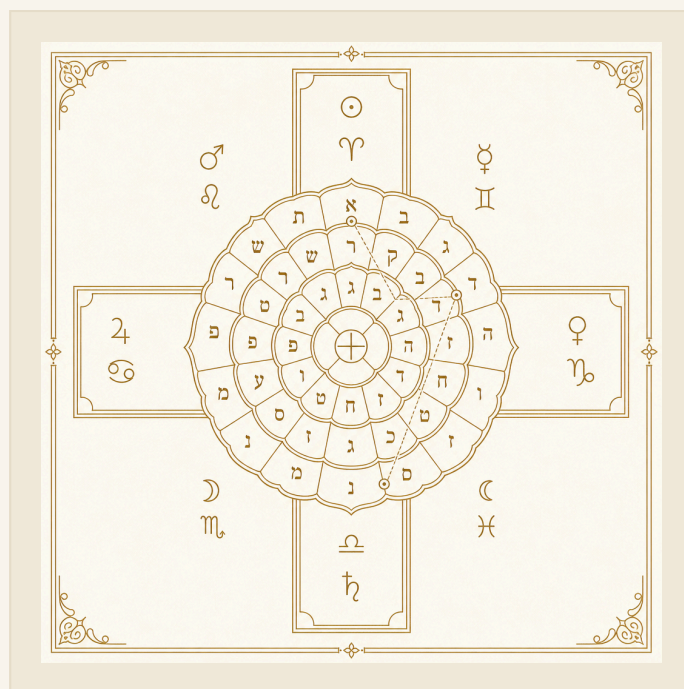
Draw the final sigil on paper. Burn it with a small flame to activate. Then genuinely forget about it: do not keep checking for results.



A number wheel with the reduced letters of an intention statement traced through it, producing the final sigil line.

Bind-runes are composite sigils made by combining two or more runes into a single symbol. They have a long history in Northern European magical practice and remain a clean, effective method for encoding specific qualities or intentions. They can be used directly, inscribed on objects, visualised in working, or combined further into more complex sigils. Common bind-rune qualities include courage, energy, good luck, grace, health, love, protection, safe travels, and strength.

The Rose-Cross lamen is a circular diagram with letters arranged in concentric rings. To create a sigil using this method, you spell out the name you want to sigillise, an archangel, a planetary spirit, a quality, a desired outcome, and trace a continuous line from letter to letter across the Rose-Cross. The resulting line is your sigil. This method is the standard approach used in the Golden Dawn tradition for producing planetary and angelic sigils.



The Rose-Cross lamén: Hebrew letters arranged in concentric rings within the rose, planetary and zodiacal glyphs on the arms of the cross. A sigil is produced by tracing a continuous line from letter to letter across the rose.

THE SIGIL OF ARCHANGEL MICHAEL

The sigil is traced by connecting M-I-C-H-A-E-L across the Rose-Cross lamén. The result is a unique geometric line that acts as a direct visual key to the Archangel's presence. Use it in protective workings, invocations, or as a focus for scrying sessions directed toward Michael's sphere.

The statement of intent matters considerably. Vague intentions produce vague results. Be specific, concrete, and state the intention as already accomplished: use I have or I am rather than I want or I will. Avoid negative constructions entirely. The unconscious processes images, not negations, and I am free from anxiety works less reliably than I am calm and steady.

METHOD	BEST SUITED TO	NOTES
Word / Letter	General everyday intentions	Fastest to learn; good default method
Rose-Cross	Angelic or planetary workings	Requires the printed or drawn lamén
Bind-Rune	Qualities: courage, protection, strength	Draws on Northern European tradition, not Qabalistic
Magic Square	Planetary-specific workings	Requires the correct square for the relevant planet

Whichever method you use, keep the final sigil visually simple. An overcomplicated glyph is harder to hold clearly in the mind's eye during charging, and the visual simplicity of the final form is part of what allows it to bypass ordinary analytical thought. If your traced result looks cluttered, simplify it further by removing lines that do not meaningfully change its overall shape.

Multiple Sigils

You can work multiple sigils at once, but keep different intents on separate sigils. Combining unrelated intents in one symbol produces muddy results.

The Forgetting

This is the hardest part for most practitioners. Obsessive checking undermines the working. If you cannot stop thinking about it, make more sigils and fire them too; volume can overcome the checking habit.

A common early mistake is treating sigil work as a substitute for practical action rather than a complement to it. If your intention statement is I have a new job, keep applying and interviewing while the sigil is active. The sigil directs subtle attention and inner energy toward the outcome; it does not remove the need for ordinary effort in the physical world.

BATCHING

Experienced sigil workers often batch several sigils together, firing a small group at once in a single short session, perhaps monthly or seasonally. This keeps the practice consistent without turning every minor wish into its own separate ritual, and it also helps considerably with the forgetting stage, since attention is naturally spread across several workings rather than fixed on just one.

A sigil journal kept alongside your working notebook is worth the small extra effort. Record the original statement of intent, the date fired, and the method used, but deliberately do not record outcomes as they happen, since checking for results is exactly the habit you are trying to avoid. Review the journal as a whole only after several months, at which point genuine patterns of success and failure across your practice become far easier to see honestly.

Sigil work combines naturally with the other systems in this guide. A sigil can be visualised at the close of a scrying or projection session as a way of sealing an intention formed during the working, or projected astrally as one of its firing methods. Treat it as one tool among several rather than a stand-alone practice, and it will integrate cleanly into whichever working structure you have already built.

Firing Methods

Burn, bury, dissolve in water, project into a candle flame, engrave and wear, or inscribe on food or drink and consume. Choose a method that genuinely signals completion and release.

Materials

Paper is fine. Wood, clay, wax, and metal are also used. The material is less important than the clarity of intention and the genuineness of the firing and release.

Putting It Together

Here is a straightforward template for a complete astral working session that integrates the skills covered in this guide. Adapt it to your own practice and the specific working you are doing, but keep all the foundational stages. The tendency to skip preparation is the most common cause of poor results.

① **Prep and Clear**

Settle your space and mind before beginning. Clear physical and mental clutter.

② **Relax and Breathe**

Run a full progressive relaxation and settle into square or steady breathing.

③ **Focus and Symbolise**

Bring your chosen symbol, doorway, or intention clearly into the inner visual field.

④ **Protect and Banish**

Perform your protective work, such as the LBRP, before opening to contact.

⑤ **Main Working**

Carry out the scrying, projection, pathworking, or sigil work that is the purpose of the session.

The recording stage is not optional. The astral fades from memory very rapidly, faster than dreams. Write everything immediately, including what seems trivial or unclear. Patterns emerge over multiple sessions that are invisible in any single one. Your working journal is a primary research tool, not just a diary.

IF TIME IS SHORT

Prioritise the relaxation and the protective work. Never skip both.

Solo Practice

The default format for most of this material. Keep a consistent time and place; the body and mind settle faster into familiar conditions, and a fixed rhythm builds the skill considerably faster than irregular practice.

Working With Others

Group scrying, shared pathworking, and comparing logged sessions afterward are valuable once the individual skills are solid. Never rely on group work as a substitute for building your own reliable solo practice first.

Choose your working space with some care, though elaborate ritual furnishing is not required. A corner that is reliably quiet, at a time when you will not be interrupted, does more for the quality of a session than any amount of incense or decoration. Consistency of place and time is itself a form of preparation, since the mind learns to settle more quickly in a space it associates with this specific kind of work.

A sample full session, combining several chapters into one working, might run as follows. This is illustrative rather than prescriptive: substitute your own preferred symbol, guide, or intention at each stage once the shape of the session is familiar to you.

STAGE	DURATION	CONTENT
Settle	5 min	Physical space prepared, distractions removed, journal and pen within reach
Relaxation	10-15 min	Full Progressive Deep Relaxation, toes to crown
Breath	3-5 min	Square breathing, colour and element layer active
Protection	5 min	Banishing ritual or protective sign sequence of your choice
Main working	15-30 min	Tattwa or mirror scrying, pathworking, or Inner Guide contact
Return	2-3 min	Deliberate retracing of the doorway used to enter, full grounding
Record	10 min	Full written record while the material is still fresh

Notice that the actual novel content of any given session, the part unique to that day's working, is a relatively small proportion of the total time. This is correct and expected. The surrounding structure is what makes that core content reliable and repeatable, rather than a matter of chance.

Weekly Rhythm

Most practitioners find two to four sessions a week sustainable long-term, with one longer or deeper session and the remainder shorter maintenance practices (breath, symbol-holding, Trataka).

Signs of Overreach

Persistent fatigue, irritability, disturbed ordinary sleep, or a felt sense of being scattered during the day are all signals to scale back and consolidate rather than push forward.

This guide has moved from the foundational skills of relaxation, breath, and concentration through the forms and territory of projection, into protection and inner guidance, and finally into the doorway systems and directed will-work that make up the more advanced end of the practice. Treat it as a working manual to return to, not a book to read once. Each chapter rewards repeated, patient return far more than a single careful reading.

A CLOSING NOTE

None of the material here substitutes for direct, logged, repeated practice. Read a chapter, then go and do the work it describes before moving to the next. The value of this guide is realised entirely in the doing, not in the reading, and the bibliography that follows is there to deepen specific areas once your own practice has shown you where you need it most.

IF YOU HAVE TIME FOR...	FOCUS ON	SKIP FOR NOW
Ten minutes	Trataka or square breathing maintenance only	Full sessions of any kind
Thirty minutes	Full relaxation plus one scrying or symbol session	Extended pathworking or deep projection
One hour or more	The full template: settle, relax, protect, work, record	Nothing; this is a complete session

FURTHER READING

BIBLIOGRAPHY

Bibliography and Further Reading

The following texts represent a strong foundation for serious study of astral work in the Western esoteric tradition. They range from accessible practical manuals to denser reference works, with something for every level of engagement.

- **Inner Landscapes**, Dolores Ashcroft-Nowicki. Excellent practical guide to guided inner journey work and pathworking from a working practitioner.
- **Magical Tattwa Cards**, Dr John Mumford. The definitive practical guide to the Tattwa system for Western practitioners. Includes a full set of cards.
- **Visual Magick**, Jan Fries. Highly practical, unconventional, and direct. Particularly strong on visualisation training and working with the inner faculties.
- **Astral Doorways**, J.H. Brennan. The clearest introductory text on the practical mechanics of astral projection and scrying. Start here.
- **Practical Psychic Self-Defence**, Robert Bruce. Thorough, systematic, and based on direct experience. Essential reading before doing serious astral work.
- **Psychic Self Defence**, Dion Fortune. The classic text. Older language, but the content remains valid and is drawn from considerable personal experience.
- **The Complete Golden Dawn System of Magic**, Ed. Israel Regardie. The comprehensive reference for the Western esoteric tradition. Use as a reference rather than reading cover to cover.

A NOTE ON SOURCES

This material draws on the Golden Dawn current and the wider Western esoteric tradition. Students are encouraged to bring questions about specific correspondences or techniques into class discussion.